Chrysler Valiant Chrysler Valiant Charger (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - I

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Chrysler Valiant | Model: Chrysler Valiant Charger | Australian Market Years: 1971-1978
Vehicle Type: Coupe | Segment: Sports Coupe / Muscle Car | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Tonsley Park, South Australia

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Chrysler Valiant Charger is one of the most charismatic muscle cars in Australian history. Launched in August 1971 with the memorable 'Hey Charger!' television advertising campaign, the Charger was built on a shortened 105-inch wheelbase with stunning fastback proportions, winning the 1971 Wheels Car of the Year award. Immortalized by the legendary Bathurst homologation specials?the E38 (280 bhp) and the triple-Weber E49 'Six Pack' (302 bhp)?the Charger was the fastest-accelerating Australian production car for over a decade, holding the standing quarter-mile record at 14.4 seconds.

Engineered under John Ellis by chopping 6 inches out of the VH sedan wheelbase and styling an aerodynamic fastback tail, the Charger captured 50% of all Australian sports coupe sales in its first year. The racing program was developed in secret with Italian carburettor masters Weber: the E49 engine featured three twin-choke Weber 45 DCOE carburettors, a high-lift camshaft, tuned exhaust headers, and a heavy-duty Borg-Warner 4-speed manual gearbox. Production continued through VJ, VK, and CL series, concluding with the colorful 1977-78 Charger Drifter.

SERIES / GENERATION: VH (VH Charger Series) [1971-1973]

Body Styles: 2-door sports coupe | ANCAP: None
1971 Wheels Car of the Year winner; 'Hey Charger!' advertising icon; Charger XL, 770, R/T (E37, E38 280 bhp), and the ultimate E49 Six Pack (302 bhp, 3x Weber, 4-speed manual).

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Hemi-265-E38: 4.3L (4342cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (100 Octane)) | 209.0 kW / 420.0 Nm
- Hemi-265-E49: 4.3L (4342cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (100 Octane)) | 225.0 kW / 441.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Charger R/T (E49): Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed close-ratio manual (Borg-Warner), AUD $3975-$4500, F
- Charger 770: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=Torqueflite 3-speed auto, 4-speed manual, AUD $3395-$4200, Fuel=14

Factory Configurations:

* Charger R/T (E49) | 2-door sports coupe | Hemi-265-E49 | 4-speed close-ratio manual (Borg-Warner) | R

SERIES / GENERATION: CL (CL Charger Series) [1976-1978]

Body Styles: 2-door sports coupe | ANCAP: None
Final Charger generation. 770 luxury sports and the iconic Drifter pack with bold side striping, roof-mounted spoiler, and 4.3L Hemi 4-speed manual.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Hemi-265-CL: 4.3L (4342cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 151.0 kW / 355.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Charger Drifter: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual (Borg-Warner), AUD $6890-$7650, Fuel=14.5L/100k

Factory Configurations:

* Charger Drifter | 2-door sports coupe | Hemi-265-CL | 4-speed manual (Borg-Warner) | RWD | 151.0kW/35